

the appropriate radio button. Once that is done and you are online, you can start chatting. Yahoo! Messenger has a slew of features, which sometimes seems a bit of overkill. You have a whole load of animated smileys for



Themes (called IMVironments) in Yahoo! Messenger

every mood under the sun, and then some. There are specific themes called IMVironments; you can set these while chatting with friends. Unlike Gtalk's chat themes, both you as well as your friend will be able to see the selected theme, so don't be surprised if you suddenly see the chat window swimming with fishes—it's the fish-tank theme. Some IMVs are interactive, allowing both of you to draw doodles using the cursor.

Another fun feature is the ability to send sound bytes in a variety of languages and in different moods. The most fun are the Insults, where you can send quite a few insults, some in languages other than English. Using a feature called Soundboard, you can also insert sounds like bumps and groans to insert that extra realism into chats. The Soundtrack feature will allow you to let a choice MP3 file play while you are chatting, and your friend will also hear the track if he or she wishes to.

Apart from enabling chats, you can also make voice calls from PC to PC or PC to phone. Available only for Windows, these VoIP features are integrated under Yahoo! Voice. You can access Yahoo! Voice from the main chat window after logging in. PC to phone calls need credit (a call to the US costs \$0.01, or about 40 paise per minute), which comes in packages upwards from \$10 (Rs 400). Get the complete list from [http://voice.yahoo.com/phone\\_rates.php](http://voice.yahoo.com/phone_rates.php). Yahoo! Voice has a Phone In and Phone Out: Phone Out is the regular voice calls you can make from your PC to any phone, mobile or landline in over 30 countries at very low rates. Check out the rates at [http://voice.yahoo.com/phone\\_calls.php](http://voice.yahoo.com/phone_calls.php).

Phone In is a feature where your computer gets a normal phone number, which can be called from any other phone. You just accept the incoming call and start talking. If you're tired of